CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

EXECUTIVE ASSISTANT IN THE AI ERA

The seat is real and it pays $76,590. It's also not for sale to beginners — BLS requires 'several years' of the job below it, and that job is shrinking −6%.

★ TL;DR — NO — as an entry. The executive seat itself is the most durable on the BLS secretary page: median $76,590 (May 2025), growth 0%, 489,300 jobs holding flat. But it is not a 2027 first job: BLS states executive assistants 'typically need several years of related work experience' in other administrative positions — and the only feeder, general admin work, is the −6% AI-exposed layer. The roadmap below is the way AROUND: reach the same altitude through operations and projects, where experience counts without passing through the shrinking seat. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

OUR TAKE: NO — NOT IN 2027

MEDIAN ~$77K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK MEDIUM

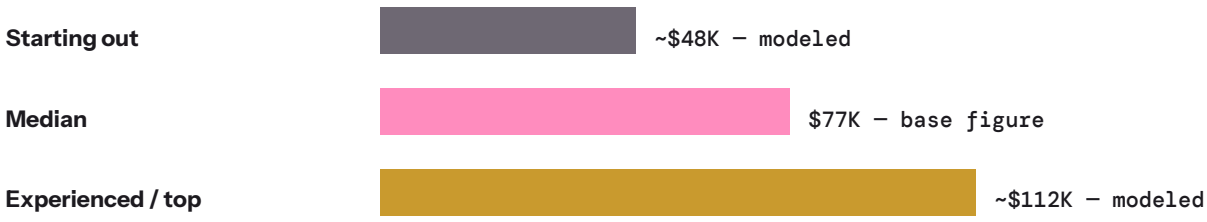
- Fails as a start because: you cannot be hired into it. Several years of prior admin experience is the published gate, and live postings agree (3+ years executive support; 5–7 at CEO level).

- The feeder problem: the years BLS wants are spent as a general administrative assistant — the subcategory shrinking −6% (−114,100 jobs) under Copilot/Gemini feature pressure.

- Still worth money: the layer above automation — gatekeeping, discretion, research, document review for top executives. It survives at 0% growth with a +61% pay premium over general admin. You just have to arrive from a direction that still exists.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Executive Assistant is a ~$77K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A EXECUTIVE ASSISTANT ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Manage executives' calendars, travel and meeting logistics
- ✓ Review incoming documents; conduct research; prepare reports
- ✓ Handle confidential correspondence and screen what reaches the top
- ✓ Sometimes supervise clerical staff and office budgets

Think: chief of staff in miniature — a trust position disguised as a support job, handed only to people who've already proven discretion somewhere.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
The transactional layer — scheduling, inbox triage, drafted follow-ups, travel booking — is being absorbed by Copilot and Gemini features, and BLS notes each EA now supports more managers than before. WEF even lumps executive secretaries into its #5-fastest-declining clerical group (−28%).	Discretion, judgment and access: deciding what the CEO sees, what waits, and what never gets in. That layer is why the executive subcategory holds at 0% while general admin falls −6% — and why it's gated behind proven years instead of a course.

⚠ **Vendor math like 'one EA supports 4–5 executives' is marketing, not BLS data — the only primary-source fact is ratio compression in one direction: more managers per EA. A flat pool of 489,300 seats, filled by promotion, against incumbents who already have the years: that is the real competition.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Proximity to power and real information ✓ The best pay on the admin ladder — $76,590 median ✓ Work built on trust, which compounds	✗ Reachable only after years in the declining feeder seat ✗ Your calendar belongs to someone else's priorities ✗ A flat occupation: 489,300 → 489,200 jobs in a decade

Good fit? You're discreet, unflappable and want the trust layer — and you're willing to earn the years in operations or projects that still grow.

Bad fit? You need the EA title in 2027; the gate is experience, and no course sells it.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — PIVOT TO Operations Manager	DOOR B — PIVOT TO Project Manager
BLS median $105,770, growth +5% — the actual top of the administrative ladder, reached by running things instead of supporting runners. Operations managers own budgets, processes, vendors and staff: the EA's judgment layer with a P&L; attached and no 'several years as an assistant' gate — coordination and supervision experience counts from any industry. First move: take ownership of one recurring operation where you are — scheduling, purchasing, onboarding — and document the system you built.	BLS median $102,320, growth +7%. Executive support is project work in disguise: deadlines, stakeholders, confidential deliverables, moving pieces that must land together. Project coordinator seats are the honest entry — they hire for exactly that stack and promote on delivery, not on years served as someone's assistant. First move: write the one-page plan for a project you've actually shepherded — owners, dates, risks, outcome.

Smart move: Reframe every support win as an operations win: not 'scheduled the retreat' but 'delivered a 40-person event under budget with zero escalations'. Altitude is a language.
Where you land after: You land in the rooms the EA supports — running operations or projects of your own, with the salary band ($102–106K medians) that trust and scope actually pay.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
READ THE	PRICE THE	PICK YOUR	COLLECT SCOPE	APPLY AT	ARRIVE WITH

STEP 1 — Read the gate

FREE · TODAY

- Find BLS's sentence: 'several years of related work experience' — that's the whole verdict
- Check live EA postings: 3+ years executive support is the floor, not the exception

STEP 2 — Price the feeder honestly

WEEK 1

- The qualifying years run through general admin: −6%, −114,100 jobs
- Choose a feeder that grows instead: coordination inside operations or projects

STEP 3 — Pick your door

WEEK 2

- Door A for scope: operations — budgets, vendors, processes
- Door B for structure: projects — plans, stakeholders, delivery

STEP 4 — Collect scope proof

WEEKS 2-8

- Own one system end-to-end and write down its numbers
- Discretion stories count too — tell them without betraying the confidence

STEP 5 — Apply at coordinator altitude

WEEKS 4-10

- Project coordinator, operations coordinator, office manager postings
- Pitch delivered outcomes; let the assistant titles go to the software

STEP 6 — Arrive with leverage

ONGOING

- From a coordinator/manager seat, the executive-support world opens sideways — chief-of-staff and ops roles
- Same rooms, same trust layer, without the shrinking staircase

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- Today: read BLS's experience gate and three live EA postings side by side.
- Days 1–30: door chosen; one system taken over and documented.
- Days 31–60: scope proof written; coordinator applications out.
- Days 61–90: interviews pitched on outcomes and discretion.
- Day 90: you're climbing the ladder that still has rungs — operations or projects — toward the same altitude the EA seat promised.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **EARN THE ALTITUDE ELSEWHERE.** ★